

Running Linux on Windows is Easy

Once thought of as rivals, circumstances have made Windows and Linux come together. The introduction of Windows Subsystem for Linux (WSL) has made it easy to install Linux on Windows. This brings great benefits to developers who need to work on both Windows and Linux, and to those who have to test apps that work on both OSs.

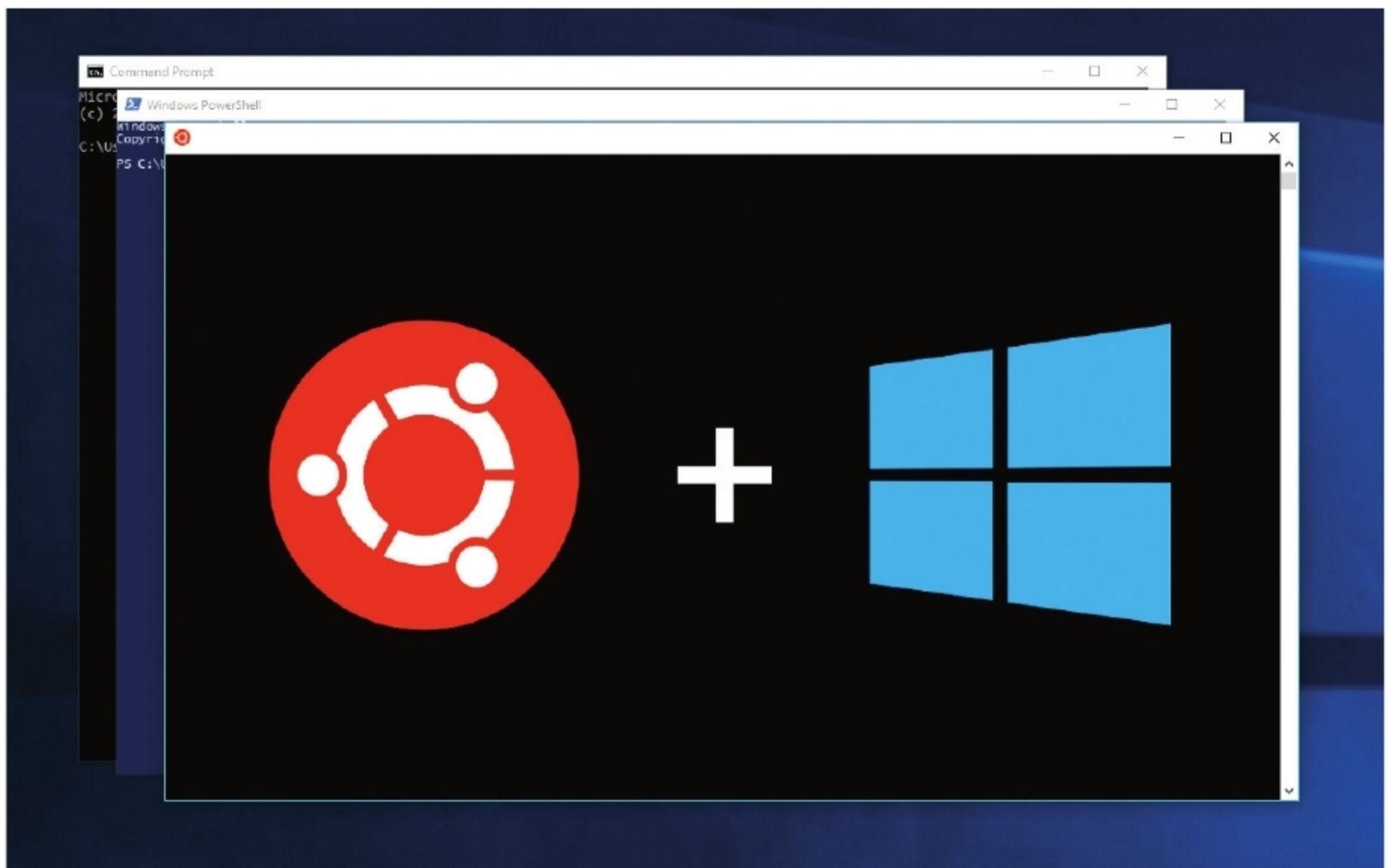


Figure 1: Windows and Linux can coexist peacefully (Source: Doug McClurg)

Most Windows users have, at some point in their lives, had a friend extol the virtues of operating systems based on variants of Linux. This is of course, apart from listening to Apple fans gleefully praising the latest MacOS updates. But after the Butterfly Keyboard fiasco, followed by the 'cheese grater' Mac Pro, there has been

quiet agreement that Apple might be testing the patience of its user base a bit too much. Not too long ago, installing a new operating system to check it out required a significant bit of technical expertise relating to partitioning a hard disk, creating a bootable media device, or even running a live-boot operation which was designed to take minimal effort. However, today we're going

to take a look at the alternative that Windows users have – to try out the Linux operating system without most of this pain, given the introduction of supporting software, tools, and ecosystems on Microsoft Windows.

Microsoft has been working for some time now towards becoming more integrated with open source software. This started off around